Introduction

> *"Treat people as if they were what they ought to be and you help them to become what they are capable of being."*
>
> *Johann Wolfgang Von Goethe*

Advocates (INFJs) may be the rarest personality type of all, but they certainly leave their mark on the world. Idealistic and principled, they aren't content to coast through life – they want to stand up and make a difference. For Advocate personalities, success doesn't come from money or status but from seeking fulfillment, helping others, and being a force for good in the world.

While they have lofty goals and ambitions, Advocates shouldn't be mistaken for idle dreamers. People with this personality type care about integrity, and they're rarely satisfied until they've done what they know to be right. Conscientious to the core, they move through life with a clear sense of their values, and

they aim never to lose sight of what truly matters – not according to other people or society at large, but according to their own wisdom and intuition.

> *INFJ personalities might come across as somewhat reserved, but they are fueled by a profound internal passion. Stimulated by deep, reflective thought and an enormous amount of empathy, they dedicate themselves to the pursuit of purpose.*

Seeking Purpose

Perhaps because their personality type is so uncommon, Advocates tend to carry around a sense – whether conscious or not – of being different from most people. With their rich inner lives and their deep, abiding desire to find their life purpose, they don't always fit in with those around them. This isn't to say that Advocates can't enjoy social acceptance or close relationships – only that they sometimes feel misunderstood or at odds with the world.

Fortunately, this sense of being out of step doesn't diminish Advocates' commitment to making the world a better place.

Advocates are troubled by injustice, and they typically care more about altruism than personal gain. They often feel called to use their strengths – including creativity, imagination, and sensitivity – to uplift others and spread compassion.

> *Nothing lights up Advocates like changing someone else's life for the better.*

Many Advocates see helping others as their mission in life, and they're always looking for ways to step in and speak up for what is right. People with this personality type also aspire to fix society's deeper problems, in the hope that unfairness and hardship can become things of the past. At times, however, Advocates may focus so intently on their ideals that they don't take adequate care of themselves – a pattern that can lead to stress and burnout.

Connecting with Others (and Themselves)

Advocates may be Introverted, but they value deep, authentic relationships with others. Few things bring these personalities as much joy as truly knowing another person – and being known

in return. Advocates enjoy meaningful conversations far more than small talk, and they tend to communicate in a way that is warm and sensitive. This emotional honesty and insight can make a powerful impression on the people around them.

> *A few close relationships, provided that they're genuine, can fill Advocates' hearts to the brim.*

Thoughtful and compassionate, Advocates pour a great deal of energy and care into their relationships. This doesn't mean that they always feel appreciated in return. Advocates tend to act with great thought and care, and it can frustrate them when other people don't recognize their good intentions. As a result, even constructive criticism may feel incredibly personal or hurtful to these personalities.

A Personal Mission

Many Advocates feel that their life has a unique purpose – a mission that they were put onto this earth to fulfill. For people with this personality type, one of the most rewarding aspects of

life is seeking out this purpose – and then, once they've found it, striving to do it justice.

When Advocates encounter inequity or unfairness, they rarely give up – instead, they consult their intuition and their compassion to find a solution. With their innate ability to balance the heart with the head, Advocates are hardwired to right the wrongs of the world, no matter how big or small. These personalities just need to remember that while they're busy taking care of everyone else, they need to pause sometimes and take care of themselves as well.

Strengths & Weaknesses

Advocate (INFJ) Strengths

- **Creative** – Advocates aren't exactly like everyone else – and that's a wonderful thing. People with this personality type embrace their creative side, always on the lookout for opportunities to express themselves and think outside the box.

- **Insightful** – These personalities know all too well that appearances can be misleading. Advocates strive to move beyond superficiality and seek out the deeper truths in life. This can give them an almost uncanny ability to understand people's true motivations, feelings, and needs.

- **Principled** – Advocates tend to have strong beliefs and values, particularly when it comes to matters of ethics. When Advocates talk about topics close to their heart, their conviction and heartfelt idealism can inspire and persuade even the sternest of skeptics.

- **Passionate** – Advocates crave a sense of purpose in life. Rather than living on autopilot or sticking to the status quo, they want to chase after their ideals. This isn't a personality type that shies away from big dreams – in fact, Advocates are energized and impassioned by the beauty of their visions for the future.

- **Altruistic** – People with this personality type aren't happy to succeed at another person's expense. Advocates want to use their strengths for the greater good, and they rarely lose sight of how their words and actions might affect others. In their heart of hearts, they want to make the world a better place, starting with the people around them.

Advocate (INFJ) Weaknesses

- **Sensitive to Criticism** – Advocates aren't averse to feedback – that is, unless they believe that someone is challenging their most cherished principles or values. When it comes to the issues that are near and dear to them, people with this personality type can become defensive or dismissive.

- **Reluctant to Open Up** – Advocates value honesty and authenticity, but they're also private. They may find it difficult to open up and be vulnerable about their struggles, not wanting to burden someone else with their issues. Unfortunately, when Advocates don't ask for help, they may inadvertently hold themselves back or create distance in their relationships.

- **Perfectionistic** – The Advocate personality type is all but defined by idealism. While this is a wonderful quality in many ways, it doesn't always leave room for the messiness of real life. Advocates might find it difficult to appreciate their jobs, living situations, or relationships if they're continually fixating on imperfections and wondering whether they should be looking for something better.

- **Avoiding the Ordinary** – Advocates yearn to do extraordinary things with their lives. But it's hard to achieve anything extraordinary without breaking it down into small, manageable steps. Unless they translate their dreams into everyday routines and to-do lists, Advocates may struggle to turn their grand visions into reality.

- **Prone to Burnout** – Advocates' perfectionism and reserve leave them with few options for letting off steam. People with this personality type can exhaust themselves if they don't balance their drive to help others with necessary self-care and rest.

Romantic Relationships

> *"Love comes more naturally to the human heart than its opposite."*
>
> *Nelson Mandela*

Advocates (INFJs) look for depth and meaning in their relationships – and their romantic relationships are no different. This is a personality type known for having a vibrant, vivid imagination, but few Advocates can imagine themselves settling for a match founded on anything less than true love.

It can take time for Advocates to find a compatible partner. Some people might think that Advocates are too choosy, and it's true that these personalities can be prone to unrealistic expectations. With their perfectionistic, idealistic nature, Advocates might be tempted to hold out for a "perfect" partner or relationship that ultimately doesn't exist. The good news? Advocates' idealism – if balanced with just enough realism – can actually enhance their love life.

Is This for Real?

Advocates tend to be attuned to their core values, keenly aware of what matters to them on a soul level. This helps them look beyond surface-level attraction and understand whether they're compatible with someone on a deeper, more meaningful level. These insights are essential for helping Advocates avoid matches that aren't founded on authenticity or shared principles.

Advocates care about integrity, and they tend to bristle when people try to change them or talk them into something that they don't believe. As a result, Advocate personalities gravitate toward partners who appreciate them as they are.

> *As romantic partners, Advocates are warm, caring, honest, and insightful - and they patiently work to uncover their loved one's innermost needs and desires.*

Once Advocates do find a suitable relationship, they rarely take it for granted. Instead, they tend to look for ways to grow as individuals and strengthen their connection with their partner.

This can help Advocates' relationships reach a level of depth and sincerity of which many people can only dream.

The Power of Love

People with this personality type create a depth to their relationships that can hardly be described in conventional terms. Because of their sensitivity and insight, Advocates can make their partners feel heard and understood in beautiful ways. Advocates aren't afraid to express their love, and they feel it with all their hearts.

> *One of the things that Advocates find most important is establishing genuine, deep connections with the people they care about.*

Advocates tend to recognize that love isn't a passive emotion but rather an opportunity to grow and learn, and they expect their partners to share this mindset. As a result, relationships with these personalities are not for the uncommitted or the shallow. Advocates are intensely passionate in ways that transcend the

present moment, and what truly fulfills them is the way that a loving, meaningful relationship evolves and deepens over time.

In their heart of hearts, people with the Advocate personality type crave an emotional and even spiritual connection with their partner. They cherish not just the act of being in a relationship but also what it means to become one with another person in mind, body, and soul.

Friendships

> *"The most I can do for my friend is simply be his friend."*
> *Henry David Thoreau*

Advocates (INFJs) rarely settle for shallow, superficial friendships. When it comes to social fulfillment, they aren't satisfied by casual interactions with colleagues or classmates. Advocate personalities crave authentic, meaningful friendships – friendships that allow them to share their dreams, bare their souls, and feel understood and accepted for who they are. And if that means having just one or two confidants rather than a wide circle of acquaintances, so be it.

While Advocates may seem quiet or reserved to the world at large, they absolutely light up around their close friends. Few things bring them more pleasure or delight than talking through their passions, interests, and beliefs with a kindred spirit. People with this personality type enjoy the pleasure of their own company, but Advocates still find it liberating to let their guard

down and be completely and utterly themselves with a friend they know they can trust.

Searching for a Heart of Gold

Advocates are known for having great expectations – not just for themselves but also for their friendships. High on this list of expectations is authenticity. If Advocates have to be fake or tone themselves down to gain someone's approval, then that person probably isn't the best friend for them. And it's hard for people with this personality type to respect someone who won't be honest with them in return – let alone anyone who can't be honest with themselves.

Another expectation that Advocates bring to their friendships is mutual support and growth. Having fun together is wonderful, but for these personalities, it isn't quite enough. Advocates want to surround themselves with friends who inspire them to learn and expand and improve themselves. For them, the surest way for two friends to deepen their bond is by helping each other move forward on their respective life missions.

> *In friendship, Advocates aren't just searching for someone to spend time with. They want to find a soul mate - someone who resonates with their passions and their convictions.*

This is a tall order, and Advocates may feel that it's difficult to meet the sort of friends they're seeking. Because their personality type is so rare, Advocates may meet relatively few people who really remind them of themselves. As a result, they may worry that they need to settle for less-than-fulfilling friendships – or else accept being alone.

Loyalty and Authenticity

Fortunately, people with this personality type are more than capable of finding the types of friends they long to meet – they might just have to devote additional energy to it. Sometimes these friends may be hiding in plain sight, among acquaintances whom Advocates simply don't know all that well. This personality type is known for having astute first impressions of other people, but even Advocates can miss the deeper potentials of the people they encounter on a daily basis. When they give

these people a chance, Advocates may find that they share values and attitudes that make them compatible on a deeper level.

Once they do find genuine friendships, Advocates make loyal, caring companions. At times they may even be surprised by the fierceness of the loyalty and devotion they feel toward their friends. Few situations in life bring out Advocates' bravery and commitment quite like the opportunity to stand up for a friend who needs them.

> *With their trademark warmth and enthusiasm, Advocate personalities support their friends' efforts to grow and expand their lives.*

Ultimately, the only way to be counted among Advocates' true friends is to be authentic, honest, and real. Over the years, Advocates may end up with just a few true friendships rather than a wide circle of casual acquaintances. But as long as those friendships are built on a richness of mutual understanding, Advocates wouldn't have it any other way.

Parenthood

> *"My instinct is to protect my children from pain. But adversity is often the thing that gives us character and backbone."*
>
> *Nicole Kidman*

As parents, Advocates (INFJs) have a clear vision for what matters to them: raising their children to be independent and all-around good people. Advocate personalities take their responsibilities seriously, and if they become parents, they think deeply about how they can shape their children's lives and experiences in positive ways.

Parenthood isn't easy, but few Advocates expect it to be. These personalities know that many of life's most worthwhile pursuits are also the most challenging – a mindset that helps Advocates keep sight of joy and fulfillment amid the daily struggles of raising children. In many ways, parenting allows Advocates to make wonderful use of their strengths, including creativity,

compassion, and the incredible strength of devotion that they feel toward those they love.

Be Unique, Just Like Me

Caring and loyal, Advocate parents are willing to do pretty much whatever it takes to better their children's lives. But it would be a mistake to think that parents with this personality type are pushovers. In fact, Advocates can be quite strict, because their commitment to building their children's character in the long term is rarely outweighed by momentary considerations (such as giving their child a piece of candy to help stop a tantrum).

While Advocates bring many gifts to raising children, it's important to note that no parent is perfect. At times, Advocates may hold their children to unrealistic standards that don't take into account each child's personality or stage of development. For example, they might expect their child to model the same integrity and honesty that they expect from themselves, becoming dismayed whenever their child behaves in a way that they perceive to be ungenerous or unethical. Or they might push

their child to be independent and creative and unique, seeing it as a sign of weakness if their child craves external structure and guidance.

> *Advocate parents may unconsciously project a great deal of their own beliefs and values onto their children.*

To a child, all of these expectations can feel contradictory and impossible to fulfill – and, depending on the child's personality and their developmental stage, these expectations might actually be impossible to fulfill. In adolescence, children might rebel by flouting these standards or by espousing beliefs that go against their Advocate parent's values. In this situation, Advocates may feel that their children are criticizing or rejecting them – a hurtful thing to such a sensitive personality type.

A Job Well Done

Advocates strive to make sure that their children grow up with a firm understanding of the difference between right and wrong. Parents with this personality type encourage their children to fight for a cause that they believe in and to be the best they can

be. Whatever age their children might be, Advocates can find a great deal of fulfillment and meaning simply in helping their children learn to be true to themselves.

Ultimately, Advocate parents tend to realize that it isn't a sign of failure if their children turn out differently than they'd expected. Instead, they come to see this as a sign that they've successfully raised someone who has the ability to form their own ideals. Advocates' children often come to appreciate the combination of independence and integrity with which they were raised – especially as they get older.

Career Paths

> *"It's better to fail while striving for something wonderful, challenging, adventurous, and uncertain than to say, 'I don't want to try because I may not succeed completely.'"*
>
> *Jimmy Carter*

Advocates (INFJs) long to find a career that aligns with their values and their dreams – a career that allows them to fulfill their unique mission in this world. For these personalities, a job isn't satisfying if it doesn't offer a deeper sense of purpose – no matter how good the salary is. The good news is that people with this personality type can use their creativity and determination to find work that suits their needs in just about any field.

In fact, Advocates have trouble deciding which job is best for them because they're able to imagine so many possibilities. They may see half a dozen wildly different paths forward, each with its own set of rewards. This can be exciting but also stress-inducing,

because picking just one means letting go of so many others. Advocates may even feel a sense of loss when so many doors close because one was selected.

The Search for Purpose

For Advocate personalities, jobs that involve helping and connecting with people can be deeply satisfying. It's no surprise, then, that many Advocates gravitate toward work as counselors, therapists, psychologists, social workers, teachers, yoga instructors, and spiritual leaders. They may enjoy service industry positions that allow them to interact directly and build genuine relationships with their customers. Careers in health care can also be rewarding options, including occupations such as nursing, physical or occupational therapy, medicine, nutrition, or more holistic paths such as acupuncture.

Many Advocates are passionate communicators. This explains why they are often drawn to careers in writing, creating many popular books, blogs, stories, video games, and screenplays. For people with this personality type, the opportunity to tell stories for a living can be nothing short of a dream come true. Other

Advocates might pursue music, photography, design, illustration, or fine art. Even if these artistic pursuits aren't their primary job, many Advocates find that creative side hustles offer a much-needed outlet for the themes and ideas that occupy their imaginations.

Nonprofit workplaces, from museums to nature centers to food pantries, also hold a special appeal. With their focus on serving the community rather than drawing a profit, these organizations can be a natural fit for Advocate personalities. But even in workplaces that are very much for-profit, Advocates can find ways to direct their energy and creativity toward helping others. No matter what it says on their business cards, Advocates' insight can enable them to spot unusual patterns and come up with outside-the-box solutions, creating real change in others' lives.

A Sense of Mission

Advocates are incredibly versatile, but some work environments may rub them the wrong way. This is especially true of workplaces that offer little independence or agency, forcing

employees to adhere to rigid, repetitive protocols without regard for their individual needs or strengths. People with this personality type may also chafe at the criticism and pressure that come with cutthroat, competitive work environments.

For this reason, many Advocates seek out more flexible, autonomous positions – or branch off altogether to start their own businesses. They may also find it gratifying to create bridges between seemingly disparate professional fields – for example, by writing about psychology or by being an environmental lawyer. Such hybrid careers can offer plenty of opportunities for Advocates to exercise their creativity and their love of learning.

> *Advocates tend to feel stifled unless their work allows them the freedom to act according to their conscience, their creativity, and their own common sense.*

In truth, Advocate personalities can do well in any field. To be truly happy, however, they need to find work that aligns with their values and allows them some independence. Advocates

crave opportunities to learn and grow alongside the people they are helping. When this happens, Advocates may finally feel that they are fulfilling their life's mission, contributing to the well-being of humanity on a personal level.

Workplace Habits

Advocates (INFJs) have some specific needs when it comes to a satisfying work environment. For people with this personality type, the most rewarding work allows them to help others while also growing as a person. And it's a given that an ideal career for Advocates must be in line with their individual values.

Anything that gets in the way of these values – from red tape and meaningless rules to office politics and unscrupulous coworkers – can seriously sap Advocates' motivation. This is a personality type that thrives in environments that promote fairness and equality. Most Advocates prefer not to think of themselves as above or below anyone else – no matter where they are on the job ladder.

Advocate Subordinates

Advocates value cooperation, sensitivity, and independence. As employees, they gravitate toward managers who are open-minded and willing to consider their input. Advocate personalities may become frustrated when they feel unheard, so

having a manager who listens to them can make all the difference.

> *Ideally, Advocates will find a manager whose values align with their own and who offers them encouragement and praise.*

Because Advocates tend to act on their convictions and aim to do their best, their morale can be vulnerable to criticism, particularly if it's unwarranted. Other morale killers for these personalities may include strict rules, formal structures, and routine tasks. They may find it especially dispiriting when they're asked to redo their work, particularly if it's for a reason that just doesn't seem valid to them.

Of course, a perfect work environment isn't always possible. Advocate employees with less-than-ideal managers may need to draw on their inner resilience and seek out other mentors. The good news is that people with this personality type are more than capable of handling workplace challenges, including the challenge of having a difficult manager.

Advocate Colleagues

As colleagues, Advocates can be quite popular and well respected. People with this personality type are often seen as helpful, eloquent, and capable coworkers. Among their greatest strengths is their ability to identify others' motives and understand the root causes of conflict before anyone else even senses a disturbance.

At times, efficiency may be less of a priority for Advocates than collaborating with and helping colleagues who need a boost. While this is usually a strength, there is a risk that others will take advantage of Advocates' desire to help. They may find themselves picking up the slack for their less dedicated coworkers at the expense of their own energy and well-being.

> *Advocates' determination to be helpful can leave them feeling taken advantage of.*

Although they tend to be well liked among their colleagues, Advocates are still Introverts. From time to time, they may need to step back and work alone, pursuing their own goals in their

own ways. This isn't a sign of resentment or ill will – but rather a signal of Advocates' need to balance serving others with their own self-care.

Advocate Managers

As managers, Advocates may dislike wielding their power. They prefer to think of everyone as equals, no matter what a person's business card might say. Rather than micromanage their subordinates, Advocates often prefer to empower them to think and act independently. They work hard to encourage others and promote an atmosphere of mutual respect.

> *Compassionate and fair, Advocate managers often take pride in identifying their subordinates' unique strengths.*

That's not to say that Advocates have low standards – far from it. Their sense of equality means that they expect their subordinates to live up to the standards that they set for themselves. Bosses with this personality type want their employees to be rigorous, motivated, reliable, and unfailingly honest, and they will notice if anyone misses the mark.

Advocate managers can be particularly stern if they catch someone behaving in a way that they consider unethical. These personalities have little tolerance for lapses in reliability or morality. When their employees' good intentions match their own, however, Advocate bosses work tirelessly to ensure that their entire team feels valued, fulfilled, and successful.

Conclusion

> *"In the end, it's your actions, how you respond to circumstance, that reveals your character."*
>
> *Cate Blanchett*

What you have read so far is just an introduction into the complexities of the kindhearted, creative, and incredibly rare Advocate personality type. Along the way, you may have muttered to yourself, "Wow, this is so accurate, it's a little creepy," or "Finally, someone understands me!" You may have even asked, "How do they know more about me than the people I'm closest to do?"

If you feel understood right now, it's because you are. Years of research have given us deep insights into the unique strengths and challenges of Advocates like you. We understand your creativity and your passion and your commitment to doing the right thing, but we also understand the dark side of your personality type: the nagging fear that you might not reach your

full potential and make the most of your one wild and precious life.

> *Advocates' gifts include idealism, determination, and the ability to envision a better future - but they don't just want to hear what makes them great. Advocates are committed to actually using these gifts to become better people and serve a greater purpose in this world.*

That's why we've made it our mission to help Advocates like you not only appreciate your gifts but also make the most of them. Learning about your personality type is fascinating, but there's a deeper purpose to it, too – because self-understanding is what helps you ensure that you don't miss out on whatever it is that you were put on this earth to do.

So here's our question for you, Advocate: Are you ready to take full advantage of your unique strengths – to unlock your true, exceptional potential? If so, your Premium Profile will give you new insights into your personality, your relationships, your career path, and your life's mission. This is the journey of a

lifetime – and you'll find everything you need to get started by moving on to the next section.

Assertive vs. Turbulent Advocates

While Assertive (INFJ-A) and Turbulent (INFJ-T) Advocates are likely to be more alike than different, their Identity personality trait provides some nuanced dissimilarities between the two. It impacts the way each thinks, acts, and responds to their worlds to a significant extent.

Assertive Advocates are more likely to be confident and relaxed. Turbulent Advocates are likely to question themselves more and are ordinarily more sensitive to stressors. To discover more about the general differences between Assertive and Turbulent Identities, please visit their overview page.

> *74% of Assertive Advocates feel like they effectively manage the stress in their life, compared to 28% of Turbulent Advocates.*
>
> *"HANDLING STRESS" SURVEY*

Are you a Turbulent Advocate? Check out "Turbulent Advocate Superpowers" at the bottom of this article for the deepest insights into who you are.

Turbulent and Assertive Advocates and the People in Their Lives

All Advocate individuals decide matters primarily by filtering them through their feelings, and their decisions often reflect the value they place on their morality. How they think about people and what they are going through is a defining factor for their personality type. But Turbulent Advocates are likely to turn empathizing with others up a notch when compared to Assertive Advocates.

Turbulent Advocates often let their passions lead them to great accomplishments. These are fueled by their regard for the people in their lives and concern for moral and idealistic issues. They can become overly involved in the problems of others. This involvement might even generate a kind of hyper-empathy where these personalities identify too much with those they seek to help.

If Turbulent Advocates become invested and then are not able to help to the degree they think they should, Turbulent

self-criticism can be excessively harsh. They can sink into brooding and become miserably mired in worry and regret.

> 75% of Turbulent Advocates say they are prone to seeing difficulties everywhere, compared to 42% of Assertive Advocates.
>
> "OPTIMIST OR PESSIMIST?" SURVEY

To add to this, Turbulent Advocates are more willing to exaggerate the impact of something that bothers them or hurts the people they care about. People with this personality type often interpret things as being far worse than they are. But such exaggeration is rarely on purpose or about dishonesty. It's more a reflection of their tendency to hold more negative views of things. It can genuinely reflect what they believe. But even if it comes from a good place, magnifying the problems can add unneeded stress and intensity to an already difficult situation.

When the Assertive Advocates become bothered by injustice, inequality, or the problems of others, they are more likely to respond in a hopeful manner. They may pay just as much

attention to any troubling concerns and human difficulties, but they refuse to become stressed by them.

> *35% of Turbulent Advocates feel like they are in control, even when things are going wrong, compared to 72% of Assertive Advocates.*
>
> *"OPTIMIST OR PESSIMIST?" SURVEY*

That doesn't mean these personalities aren't genuinely invested, or that they don't care. There are many ways, apart from fretting, to take an interest in the plight of others.

Assertive Advocates are more likely than their counterparts to stay on an even emotional keel when relating to others. Rather than spending a lot of time thinking about the pain and misery some may suffer, these personality types are more likely to think in terms of plans and visions that may lead to a more positive future. They can be just as intense imagining the emergence of something good as Turbulent Advocates can be about their worries and regrets.

But this optimism can, at times, have negative outcomes. Life through rose-colored glasses doesn't always promote a clear vision. Assertive Advocates might shrug off legitimately important problems that need to be addressed, choosing instead to focus on brighter things. On these occasions, they may overlook essential tasks. Turbulent Advocates are more likely to spot such things long before Assertive Advocates do.

Both Turbulent and Assertive Advocates tend to elevate their friends, the people they fall in love with, and even their colleagues. These personalities generally think the best of those they value and agree with. They might not look as kindly on those who go against their sense of right and wrong or appear to be phony.

However, there is a difference between the two: Assertive Advocates see things through a filter that values humanity and want to have people (in limited Introverted doses) in their lives. Turbulent Advocates, in comparison, are more likely to go beyond simply wanting people in their lives. These personalities feel more of a need for others and are more affected by what

others think of them. This need for others and their opinions can help them form deep bonds with others and allows them to collaborate better when that's called for.

> *38% of Turbulent Advocates find it easy to make an important decision without consulting anyone first, compared to 71% of Assertive Advocates.*
>
> *"Relying on Others" SURVEY*

However, unlike Turbulent Advocates, Assertive Advocates are not deeply influenced by the opinions of others – perhaps, at times, to their detriment. This allows these personalities to approach the various missions in their lives with independence and in a streamlined fashion.

> *73% of Turbulent Advocates feel pressured to live up to a certain standard (e.g., home, car, salary), compared to 42% of Assertive Advocates.*
>
> *"Social Pressures" SURVEY*

But at what point does this independence evolve into arrogance? All Introverted personality types prefer being alone – or, at

most, among a small group of carefully chosen people. That said, Assertive Advocates can overplay the role of the lone wolf. These Confident Individualists can become so independent that they forget the needs and wishes of others.

Turbulent Advocates can go the other way – constantly looking for approval, stifling their individuality, and thwarting their efforts as they wait for all who matter to look kindly on their actions and ideas. Pleasing everyone is a rare accomplishment in life, and pursuing it has stalled a lot of people in their tracks.

> *93% of Turbulent Advocates are often afraid of being rejected by other people, compared to 52% of Assertive Advocates.*
>
> *"Relying on Others" SURVEY*

Change, Regret, and Advocate Identity Differences

Because of their shared Judging personality trait, both types of Advocates prefer routine and predictability. Neither particularly likes to be caught by surprise.

However, Assertive Advocates are much more likely to accept an unusual turn in events, and they somewhat more readily buy into unorthodox ideas and people. They tend to be somewhat more adventurous than their Turbulent counterparts – probably by virtue of their confidence.

Turbulent Advocates, as part of their quest for ongoing improvements, are likely to embrace change, but only within reason. People with this personality type like to have some control over it and to have some guarantee that it is the right change at the right moment. They are likely to take fewer risks than their Assertive counterparts.

> *87% of Turbulent Advocates find it hard not to let a stressful event negatively affect them, compared to 47% of Assertive Advocates.*
>
> *"HANDLING STRESS" SURVEY*

Advocate personalities all share profound regard for the past. They tend to remember the way things have unfolded in their

lives deeply and passionately. They glean lessons for the future from their bygone days. However, Assertive Advocates are much less bothered by regrets when their pasts have been rocky, whereas Turbulent Advocates may cling tightly to the memories of such disappointments and missteps.

> *86% of Turbulent Advocates often feel regret, compared to 48% of Assertive Advocates.*
>
> *"REGRET: GENERAL ATTITUDES" SURVEY*

Regret can color Turbulent Advocates' future actions either positively or negatively: positively, if they are motivated to make up for past missteps; negatively, if these personalities become caught up in guilt or anger. This can be especially devastating if they believe they have harmed others.

Because regret does not impact them as much, Assertive Advocates may be less driven to fix past mistakes. If they can just brush off their failures as unimportant, they may not learn critical lessons that can be best taught by trial and error. This

may leave these personalities repeating their mistakes more often than they might like.

> *89% of Turbulent Advocates often catch themselves dwelling on past mistakes, compared to 61% of Assertive Advocates.*
>
> *"Thought Patterns" SURVEY*

Summary of Differences

- Both personality types are concerned with other people, but Assertive Advocates are likely to be more hopeful, and Turbulent Advocates to focus on the difficult parts of a problem.
- Turbulent Advocates are often fueled by their worries and concerns, and these can be used to make significant progress.
- Both Assertive and Turbulent Advocates can get caught up in the drama of life, but those who are Turbulent are likely to be affected by it more.

- Stress and regret affect the Assertive Advocate individuals less, but this should not be confused with their not caring.
- Because their regrets weigh on them more, Turbulent Advocates are more likely to learn from their mistakes than Assertive Advocates.
- Assertive Advocates are less influenced by the opinions of others than Turbulent Advocates. However, paying too little or too much attention to the opinions of others carries its own difficulties.
- Assertive Advocates are more likely to want people in their lives, while Turbulent Advocates may feel they need people in their lives.

The same but different – that's what we discover when we explore Assertive and Turbulent Identities in a single personality type. For Advocates, this means they share the same passion, the same concern for others, the same sense of order, and the same level of conviction about right and wrong.

However, it also means each personality type has a somewhat different perspective regarding the metaphorical glass. Is it half-full or half-empty? To what degree do they respond to other people and events, and to what degree do they move forward despite them? It's all part of the journey of self-exploration.

Are you a Turbulent Advocate?

Turbulent Advocates (INFJ-T) have an incredible capacity for learning and growth, but they don't always recognize their true potential. That's why we made Turbulent Advocate Superpowers: Becoming Your Best Self – without Changing Who You Are.

If you are a Turbulent Advocate, Turbulent Advocate Superpowers will empower you to let go of self-criticism and embrace who you really are. Along the way, you'll shift your mindset, improve your relationships, and go after your dreams, all by harnessing your greatest strengths – the strengths that were within you all along.

Dealing with Uncertainty

Global events over the past year or so have created a seemingly endless amount of uncertainty, fear, and frustration. While we will avoid focusing on any specific events (honestly, there are too many to address), we do want to use this opportunity to discuss the role that our personality types may play in how we deal with the challenges created by uncertainty.

The fear, lack of control, and stress that accompany uncertainty affect each personality type differently. As an Advocate, you are likely to face certain challenges and opportunities, also sharing them with other personalities in the Diplomat Role group. Let's review some examples below.

Challenges

Unlike their similarly visionary yet more utilitarian cousins, the Analysts, Diplomats are less confident in their abilities to deal with stress. And one thing that uncertainty undoubtedly creates is stress. Our research shows that Diplomats are the most likely types to:

- Feel that they cannot handle stress effectively
- Believe that when things start going wrong they keep going wrong
- Feel as though they are often overwhelmed by life
- Spend a lot of time thinking about their past actions or choices
- Feel anxious if they have several equally good options to choose from
- Find it hard to not let a moderately stressful event negatively affect them

Advocates (especially Turbulent ones) in particular find it difficult to focus under pressure and need time to pull themselves together, more so than any other personality type. Uncertainty can ultimately wreak havoc on their stress levels which can lead to decreased confidence and increased anxiety.

Opportunities

It's not all doom and gloom for Diplomats, however, as they can be remarkably flexible and resilient. While they may not score high marks on stress management, their lack of interest in

controlling people or situations prevents them from becoming too overwhelmed when life becomes unpredictable. Diplomats can make the best of uncertainty by practicing the following tips:

- Find ways to work with others, especially those who may balance out your weaknesses
- Embrace uncertainty as a prime opportunity for personal growth and self-discovery
- Take control of what you can and avoid letting other people or situations dictate your life choices – trust your inner compass

Individuals of every personality type can benefit from viewing uncertain situations as opportunities. The only certainty in life is that there will be change, and learning to use your unique strengths to adapt to this changing world is one of the most important things that you can do.